

New Engineer Onboarding Guide

1. Welcome

This guide covers everything a new engineer needs to get set up and productive in their first two weeks at Nimbus Cloud Systems.

2. Dev Environment Setup

2.1 Required Software

- Install VS Code with the team extension pack (link in #eng-onboarding Slack channel).
- Install Docker Desktop version 4.30 or later.
- Install the Nimbus CLI tool via 'brew install nimbus-cli' (Mac) or the Windows installer on the internal wiki.
- Request access to the GitHub organisation 'nimbus-cloud-systems' via IT Service Desk.

2.2 Repository Access

Once GitHub access is granted, clone the 'platform-core' repository and run 'make setup' from the root directory. This installs dependencies and configures local environment variables automatically.

2.3 VPN and Network Access

All engineers must connect via the corporate VPN (Cisco AnyConnect) before accessing internal databases or staging environments. VPN credentials are issued by IT within 24 hours of your start date.

3. Team Norms

3.1 Working Hours

Core collaboration hours are 10:00-16:00 in your local timezone. Outside these hours, flexible working is encouraged.

3.2 Stand-ups

Daily stand-ups take place at 09:30 via the team's video channel. Stand-ups are capped at 15 minutes.

3.3 Code Review Expectations

All pull requests require at least one approval before merging. Reviewers should respond within one business day. See the API and Coding Style Guide for detailed conventions.

4. First Week Checklist

- Complete security awareness training (assigned automatically via email).
- Set up two-factor authentication on your Nimbus account.
- Shadow one on-call engineer for a half-day to observe the incident response process.
- Submit your first small pull request (a 'good first issue' will be assigned by your onboarding buddy).